

“Goddess Laxmi and Saraswati are both women... Financial planning and savings and investment management are in the male domain is a myth that needs to be done away with”

DEENA MEHTA

Managing Director,
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34 | Mehra says her parents never discriminated between sons and daughters. She has two brothers, twins, five years older. Like her, both brothers are at the top of their professions.

But, at work, she saw that working women did not get involved in their family finances and investments because they felt overwhelmed by the pressure of an office job and running a household.

Amisha Vora, Chairperson and Managing Director of financial services firm Prabhudas Lilladher Group (PL Group), learnt to handle pressure early: she became a chartered accountant at 21. Her father was a banker and he encouraged her to follow in the footsteps of her uncle Nalin Shah, who had his broking firm NVS Broking. Later, her family's connection with Nimesh Kampani, Founder and Chairman of JM Financial, got her a job as a research analyst in 1998. Two years later, she joined PL Group as a Vice President of FII sales.

Over the years, the 55-year-old

has managed various facets of the business, scaled operations, diversified offerings and established robust systems.

The PL Group currently serves 160,000 clients through more than 1,000 partners across 200-plus locations, catering to corporates, institutions, family offices, HNIs, and retail clients in India and globally.

“I realised that analysing balance sheets, understanding diverse business models and adapting to market cycles kept me deeply engaged,” Vora says the path was not easy, especially after marriage.

Balancing family expectations

is the biggest challenge for working women.

“Women have to navigate the professional and personal spheres with equal dedication. I never sought special treatment or favours but focussed on absolute professionalism. If I expect equal respect, I do equal work,” Vora says.

She took on the challenge of managing PL's retail business in 2012 alongside the institutional business. “It was a steep learning curve, but I quickly adapted by building strong processes, implementing India's first e-KYC, and training my team to provide responsible financial ad-

Women fund managers say there's no perfect work-life balance. What works is effective prioritisation